

“Some of the tablet players are bringing in technology that Apple oversaw”

With the growing popularity of tablets world over, computer maker Acer too is planning to roll out its tablets in India in the next few months. The company expects tablets to contribute significantly as it targets a 25 per cent growth in its revenues in the calendar year 2011.

S. Rajendran, chief marketing officer of Acer India, speaks to Uma Bansal, executive editor at EFY, about why tablets can't be dismissed as just another fad and what consumers should expect

It has not been much time since netbooks debuted on the market, but they are already under cannibalisation threat from tablets. Do you agree?

A tablet is the hottest device off-the-shelf right now and expected to create a sizeable market but the netbook will still find its users.

Netbooks today contribute about 12 per cent of the overall notebook market. These have their usage in both the consumer segment as well as educational institutions and corporates. They offer portability and long battery life at very affordable price points.

Of course, tablets are ultra-mobile PCs that combine great functions with ease of use, but their mass adoption in India will take some time at current price points.

Both tablet PCs and netbooks will co-exist in the marketplace as these have different target audience and functionality. Both have their own advantages and disadvantages and, in fact, serve slightly different purposes.

Tablet PCs are developed to meet the demands of those consumers who are on a constant move. The device enables the users to frequently check mails, watch HD movies, play games and also use it as a book reader. Tablet PCs are built to consume more content and subsequently use them for light content creation. Netbooks, on the other hand, are built for both creating and consuming content.

What works in favour of tablets?

Tablet PCs act as true personal computers with a com-



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“Android tablets running off dual-core processors have more than enough power to handle true multitasking. Also, Android tablets come with two cameras for video chatting and video conferencing”